for Israeli democracy. He expressed the hope that the protests would turn into demonstrations by millions of people, the hope we all share. As he was speaking to supporters in front of his house, hooligans mobilized by the government were yelling “Resign!” to a man who had resigned seventeen years ago. How sad and shameful.

Speaking of shame: Netanyahu wishes to send Knesset member May Golan as consul general to New York. The lady, who left school at age fifteen, is a declared and proud racist, known for her anti-African statements. Consul in New York? A spokesperson for the State Department made clear that Golan’s language was unacceptable in the United States. How desperate can Netanyahu be?

When I come to think that in the 1950s, Arthur Lourie, to whom I was indirectly related through the marriage of one of my cousins to his brother, was Israeli consul general in New York, I cannot but wonder how far Israeli public service has come crashing down! Arthur, who over the years became director general of the Israeli Foreign Ministry, had been a law professor in South Africa before joining the prestate Jewish Agency and then the Israeli diplomatic service; he was a highly sophisticated individual, a friend, and an equal in many ways of another South African Jew and eventually Israel’s foreign minister, Aubrey “Abba” Eban. But May Golan is a Knesset member of the Likud, had an appointment in Netanyahu’s office, and knows some English.

A poll published on the evening news indicates that 60 percent of the population does not consider that this government represents them. Even more telling is the fact that on the eve of the seventy-fifth anniversary of the State of Israel, 48 percent of the population, instead of being cheered by the country’s achievements and optimistic regarding its future, think that the coming years will be worse.

Analysts estimate that Netanyahu will not necessarily abandon the present course, but will try to cool things down until after the summer. It